

Barrel Distortion

This occurs when straight lines appear bent outwards from the centre of the image. Wide angle lenses shot at their wide end will typically produce images with this kind of distortion given that they have a wider field of view to work with. In the case of portraits, you will notice how subjects can look large-headed in comparison to the rest of their body.

Barrel distortion is usually the result of standing too close to your subject with a wide angle lens at the wide end. The body part that is the closest to the camera will look larger than the rest of the body.

Pincushion Distortion

This occurs when straight lines can be seen pinching or bending inward from the centre of the image. This sort of distortion usually happens when you use the telephoto end of a zoom lens. In the case of portraits, this can be desirable for some. It gives the appearance of people being thinner than they actually are. Pincushion distortion is often seen commonly in images having straight lines. The further the lines are from the centre of the image, the more noticeable the distortion.

If you spend some time training your eye to catch distortion in-camera, you can save yourself a decent deal of time in post processing. This is especially true if you are not a fan of distortion and find yourself doing away with it in post processing. Usually all it takes is moving around a little and adjusting the plane until you get the look that you ideally want to go for. Images with buildings, doors, windows tend to see a lot of distortion. That being said, you can use Photoshop or Lightroom to remove distortion from your photographs.

File Formats And Their Pros & Cons

Every time your camera captures a photograph what it is essentially doing is capturing data. This data then creates a digital image, which is what you see as your product. There are a number of different file formats that can be used to retrieve this data or digital image. This data can also be manipulated using a photo editing software. Here's a list of the most commonly used file formats -

- JPEG (Joint Photographic Experts Group)
- TIFF (Tagged Image File Format)
- RAW
- DNG (Digital Negative Format)
- PNG (Portable Network Graphics)